

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 9 7 6 5

♥ 6 3

♦ 8

♣ 7 6 3 2

♠ K J 4

♥ K Q 9 2

♦ A Q 5

♣ K 10 8



♠ 2

♥ J 10 8 5 4

♦ 10 7 3 2

♣ A 9 4

♠ A 8 3

♥ A 7

♦ K J 9 6 4

♣ Q J 5

With balanced distribution and 16 points SOUTH should open 1NT rather than 1♦.

NORTH's response is based on simple math. He adds his 18 points to the 15 minimum that SOUTH has announced and comes up with 33 points combined. This is enough for a small slam, and since he has balanced distribution he bids 6NT.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

6NT

1NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Lead: ♠ 10

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5 3
♥ K 8 5 4 3
♦ K J 4
♣ 10 6 4

♠ Q J 10 9 6

♥ A 7

♦ A Q 6

♣ A K 7



♠ A 8 7 2

♥ J 9 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ J 3 2

♠ K 4

♥ Q 10 6

♦ 8 5 3 2

♣ Q 9 8 5

NORTH is right at the maximum for a 1♠ opening bid - one more point and he would have opened 2♣.

SOUTH does not have 3-card ♠ support but with 7 points must make some response. She cannot bid at the 2-level so she says 1NT (6-10 points).

NORTH is fine with Notrump so he bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
	1♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♥4			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5		♠ 7 2
♥ 7 3		♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ 6 5 4 2		♦ 9 8 3
♣ K Q 10 8 7 5		♣ A J 4
	♠ A K 9 6 4	
	♥ K Q 5	
	♦ K Q J 7	
	♣ 3	
		♠ Q J 10 8 3
		♥ A J 4
		♦ A 10
		♣ 9 6 2



West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5 ♥
Pass	6 ♠		
All Pass			
6 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣K			

SOUTH has a minimum 1 ♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

NORTH hears the 1 ♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether SOUTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

SOUTH has two Aces so she bids 5 ♥ (5 ♣ would show zero Aces, 5 ♦ would show one Ace, etc).

NORTH has heard enough and bids 6 ♠.

Board 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 8 3
♥ J 9 4
♦ 8 5 2
♣ 10 4 2

♠ A 7 4

♥ Q 5

♦ K 7 6 4

♣ 7 6 5 3



♠ Q 10 9 5

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 9

♣ K Q J 8

♠ 6 2

♥ A K 8 7 6 2

♦ A 10 3

♣ A 9

SOUTH has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

NORTH, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

SOUTH shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which NORTH raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 2			

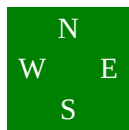
Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 2
 ♥ K 10 2
 ♦ A 10 9
 ♣ J 9 8 5 4

♠ J 10 8 3
 ♥ A Q 7 4
 ♦ J 5 3
 ♣ 7 6



♠ A 6 5
 ♥ J 9 6 5
 ♦ K Q 8 4
 ♣ 10 3

♠ K Q 7 4
 ♥ 8 3
 ♦ 7 6 2
 ♣ A K Q 2

SOUTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

NORTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1 ♥.

SOUTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and NORTH again must bid. Since NORTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2 ♠, which SOUTH happily passes.

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 9			